

MEGATREND ANALYSIS

Resilience becomes a permanent strategy setting

Structural · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

Trade fragmentation, geopolitical risk, uneven macro conditions, and multiple plausible futures replace the assumption of a stable base case.

31 vs 13

OECD countries screening inbound investment in 2023 versus 2010, as reported in the Weekly Brief archive. ^[1]

4.6% to 1.9%

WTO baseline change in merchandise-trade volume growth from 2025 to the 2026 forecast; 2027 is forecast at 2.6%. ^[2]

2.5%

World Bank forecast for global growth in 2026, down from 2.9% in 2025, with downside risks emphasized. ^[3]

What is changing - and why it matters

Resilience is no longer a contingency plan sitting beside strategy; it is part of the base design. Trade continues to grow, but routes, legal instruments, energy exposure and investment controls are changing. That distinction matters: the evidence does not support indiscriminate deglobalization, yet it does invalidate plans built around one stable geopolitical and macroeconomic path. CEOs need portfolios and networks that can switch suppliers, routes, funding sources and market emphasis without destroying economics in the base case.

Executive implication

Single-point plans become fragile; resilience and optionality carry measurable strategic value.

Action agenda

- Replace one-point plans with a small set of decision-relevant scenarios tied to triggers and pre-agreed actions.
- Price the value of optional capacity, dual sourcing, liquidity and route flexibility rather than treating them only as overhead.
- Map second- and third-order exposure across critical suppliers, energy, data, regulation and financing.

What could change the view

- Trade or investment restrictions expand from selected technologies into broader operating inputs.
- Resilience initiatives create structural complexity without measurable reduction in recovery time or earnings volatility.

Selected evidence

[1] Weekly Brief · 2024-06-24 · How to Face Rising Geopolitical Risk

- [2] Authoritative research · WTO · 2026-03-19 · Global Trade Outlook and Statistics — March 2026 · p. 4
- [3] Authoritative research · World Bank · 2026-06-16 · Global Economic Prospects — June 2026 · p. 25
- [4] Weekly Brief · 2025-01-14 · Navigating the New Dynamics of Global Trade
- [5] Weekly Brief · 2026-04-21 · Beyond Tomorrow—Four Scenarios for the World of 2050
- [6] Weekly Brief · 2026-03-24 · Infrastructure Investing Is Back
- [7] Weekly Brief · 2025-08-28 · Reflections from India—A Country Defining Its Future
- [8] Weekly Brief · 2024-09-25 · The Draghi Report—What Business Leaders Need to Know
- [9] Authoritative research · IMF · 2026-07-08 · World Economic Outlook Update: Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology
- [10] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan Global Research · 2026-07-01 · Mid-Year Market Outlook 2026: The Tug of War Continues
- [11] Authoritative research · World Economic Forum · 2026-01-14 · Global Risks Report 2026
- [12] Authoritative research · WTO · 2025-12-15 · Global Value Chain Development Report 2025: Rewiring GVCs in a Changing Global Economy

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.